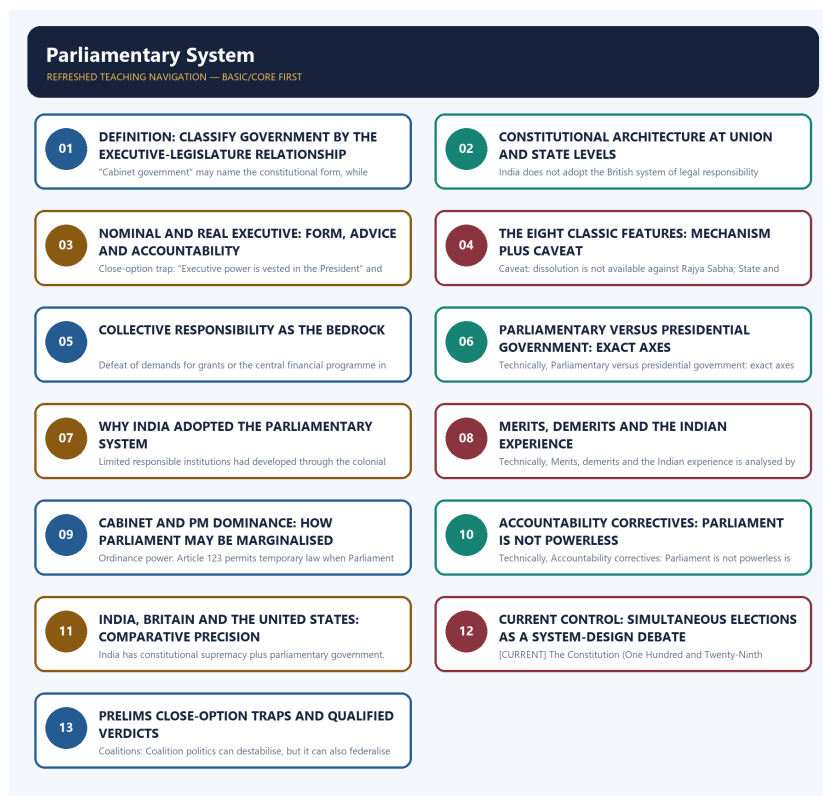


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Parliamentary System - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Polity 11 - Parliamentary System - Complete Topic Package

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Original hard MCQs

OM1. Article 74 control

Consider the following statements:

1. The President may require ministerial advice to be reconsidered once.
2. After reconsideration, the President may permanently reject the advice.
3. Article 74(2) bars inquiry into the advice but does not necessarily bar review of the resulting action.

Which is correct?

A. 1 and 3 only B. 1 only C. 1, 2 and 3 D. 2 and 3 only

Answer: A.

The 44th Amendment permits one reconsideration, after which the advice binds. Article 74(2) protects advice from inquiry; constitutional review of the action may still proceed on available material and legal grounds.

OM2. Union-State architecture

Which pairing is correct?

A. Article 166 - President's rules for Union business B. Article 167 - Chief Minister's communication duties to the Governor C. Article 88 - State Council's responsibility to Assembly D. Article 77 - collective responsibility to Lok Sabha

Answer: B.

Article 167 is the State parallel to Article 78. Article 77 concerns Union executive business, Article 88 parliamentary participation, and Article 166 State executive business.

OM3. Ministry-size controls

Consider the following:

1. Union ministry: maximum 15% of Lok Sabha strength.
2. State ministry: maximum 15% of Legislative Assembly strength.
3. State ministry: constitutional minimum of 12.
4. These caps were introduced by the 91st Amendment.

Which is correct?

A. 1 and 4 only B. 1, 2 and 4 only C. 1, 2, 3 and 4 D. 2 and 3 only

Answer: C.

Articles 75(1A) and 164(1A), inserted by the 91st Amendment, establish the two 15% caps; the State Council also has a minimum of 12.

OM4. Minister in the other House

A Union minister who belongs to Rajya Sabha attends Lok Sabha. Which statement is most accurate?

A. The minister may vote only on government bills. B. The minister may speak and vote because executive office overrides membership. C. The minister cannot speak because the minister is not a Lok Sabha member. D. The minister may speak and participate but cannot vote in Lok Sabha.

Answer: D.

Article 88 enables participation in either House, joint sittings and named committees, but gives no vote by virtue of office. Voting follows House membership.

OM5. Nominal and real executive

Which proposition best reflects *Shamsher Singh*?

A. President and Governor are formal heads ordinarily acting on responsible advice, subject to constitutionally recognised Governor discretion. B. Article 53 allows the President to govern without a Council. C. All gubernatorial discretion is unconstitutional. D. The President has a personal popular mandate equal to Lok Sabha.

Answer: A.

The case constitutionalises the formal-head position and ministerial responsibility. It does not erase specific gubernatorial discretion or create personal presidential government.

OM6. Dissolution and continuity

What was the central implication of *U.N.R. Rao v. Indira Gandhi*?

A. The President governs alone until elections. B. The Council continues because Article 74 remains mandatory even while confidence cannot be tested in a dissolved House. C. Article 75(3) is permanently suspended after dissolution. D. Lok Sabha dissolution automatically dismisses the Council.

Answer: B.

The Court harmonised continuity under Article 74 with confidence under Article 75(3). Dissolution prevents an immediate floor test; it does not terminate responsible government.

OM7. Non-member Prime Minister

Which is correct after *S.P. Anand*?

A. A Rajya Sabha member cannot become PM. B. Only an existing Lok Sabha member can become PM. C. A non-member may become PM but must enter either House within six months. D. A non-member PM may continue until the next general election.

Answer: C.

Article 75(5) permits a six-month window. The Indian Constitution does not import the British convention that the PM must sit in the Commons.

OM8. Floor-test doctrine

Which statement is the most precise use of *S.R. Bommai* in this topic?

A. It gives Governors unrestricted discretion to assess support privately. B. It makes every Union bill a confidence vote. C. It abolishes Article 356. D. It supports floor determination of disputed Assembly majority and judicial review of Article 356 material.

Answer: D.

Bommai's main operational field is State government and President's Rule. It supports the wider responsible-government principle that legislative support is tested in the House.

OM9. Collective responsibility

Which statement best captures collective responsibility?

A. The ministry must retain Lok Sabha confidence and publicly stand by settled cabinet policy as a team. B. Rajya Sabha may dismiss the Council through no-confidence. C. Cabinet disagreement is legally prohibited even inside meetings. D. Every minister is individually elected by Lok Sabha.

Answer: A.

Collective responsibility combines confidence and solidarity. Internal debate is possible; public opposition while remaining in office conflicts with cabinet solidarity.

OM10. Financial defeat

Which is the safest constitutional formulation?

A. Defeat of any government amendment automatically removes the ministry. B. Express confidence defeat or denial of essential supply is decisive/grave; ordinary legislative defeat requires contextual assessment. C. Rajya Sabha rejection of a Money Bill dismisses the Council. D. The Budget has no relationship with confidence.

Answer: B.

Parliamentary convention treats supply as essential to governing, but not every adverse division is automatically a confidence loss. Lok Sabha is the confidence chamber.

OM11. Political homogeneity

In a coalition ministry, political homogeneity is best understood as:

A. a prohibition on regional parties entering government. B. a constitutional requirement that every minister belong to one party. C. negotiated consensus around a common programme rather than identical ideology. D. automatic loss of office whenever partners disagree.

Answer: C.

Homogeneity is a classic political tendency. Coalition government adapts it through agreed programmes and cabinet solidarity.

OM12. Secrecy

Which statement is correct?

A. Secrecy is merely a political convention with no constitutional oath. B. Cabinet secrecy prevails over every court order. C. The oath of secrecy eliminates Parliament's right to seek information. D. Secrecy protects candid deliberation but coexists with legislative, judicial, audit and statutory accountability.

Answer: D.

Ministers take the Third Schedule oath. Its purpose is not absolute executive opacity.

OM13. System comparison

Which combination correctly distinguishes parliamentary from presidential government?

A. Confidence-dependent ministry, legislative membership and possible lower-House dissolution. B. Lower-House confidence with President unable to dissolve it in any circumstance. C. Separate executive selection with ministerial membership of Congress. D. Fixed executive tenure, collective responsibility and fusion.

Answer: A.

The parliamentary cluster is responsibility, double membership and dissolution. Presidential government features separate selection, fixed tenure and separation.

OM14. US executive terminology

Which is correct?

A. US secretaries remain members of Congress while serving. B. US cabinet secretaries are formal executive officers; "kitchen cabinet" refers to informal advisers. C. "Kitchen Cabinet" is the constitutional collective name for US departmental secretaries. D. The House of Representatives can dismiss the US cabinet by no-confidence.

Answer: B.

The informal label must not be confused with the formal cabinet. The presidential executive is not collectively responsible to Congress.

OM15. India-Britain difference

Consider the following:

1. India is a republic; Britain a constitutional monarchy.
2. India has a written supreme Constitution; Britain follows parliamentary sovereignty.
3. India's PM may be from either House; Britain's PM is by convention from the Commons.

Which is correct?

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1, 2 and 3 D. 1 only

Answer: C.

All three distinctions are central. India constitutionalised Westminster responsibility without importing Crown heredity or parliamentary legal omnipotence.

OM16. Adoption rationale

Which was **not** a defensible reason for India's adoption of parliamentary government?

- A. Preference for daily responsibility B. Accommodation of plural representation C. Familiarity with responsible institutions D. Desire to make Parliament legally sovereign over the Constitution

Answer: D.

India chose responsible government under constitutional supremacy. The design rejected British-style unlimited parliamentary sovereignty.

OM17. Coalition evidence

Which conclusion is best supported by Indian experience?

- A. Coalitions can be unstable, but full-term coalitions show instability is conditional rather than inherent. B. Single-party governments cannot produce cabinet dominance. C. Every coalition necessarily collapses before five years. D. Anti-defection guarantees perfect cabinet stability.

Answer: A.

Short-lived governments demonstrate risk; full-term NDA and UPA coalitions demonstrate negotiated stability. Institutional incentives and political conditions matter.

OM18. Cabinet-dominance chain

Which sequence is most accurate?

- A. Federalism -> fixed tenure -> no dissolution B. Majority + whip -> agenda/time control -> reduced scrutiny, qualified by committees and confidence power C. Rajya Sabha no-confidence -> PM dismissal D. Judicial review -> cabinet secrecy -> parliamentary sovereignty

Answer: B.

The majority-whip-agenda mechanism explains practical dominance. It is checked, not erased, by scrutiny institutions.

OM19. PRS evidence

Which statement reflects the verified PRS anchor used in this package?

- A. The 17th Lok Sabha sat more than every earlier full-term House. B. All Bills in the 17th Lok Sabha were referred to committees. C. It sat 274 days, while committee referral was lower than in the 16th and 15th Lok Sabhas. D. PRS found that parliamentary committees had been abolished.

Answer: C.

PRS reported 274 sitting days and a 16% referral rate, down from 26% in the 16th and 71% in the 15th Lok Sabha.

OM20. Simultaneous-elections control

As of 28 August 2026, which is correct?

- A. Parliament has enacted a mandatory implementation year. B. Article 82A is operative constitutional law. C. The Joint Committee has conclusively upheld every provision. D. The 129th Amendment Bill remains a proposal under Joint Committee consideration.

Answer: D.

The Bill was introduced on 17 December 2024 and remains under committee review. No enacted Article 82A or implementation year may be asserted.

OM21. Articles 77 and 78

Which pairing is correct?

- A. Article 77 - form/authentication/allocation of Union business; Article 78 - PM's information duties to President. B. Article 77 - State business; Article 78 - Governor discretion. C. Article 77 - no-confidence; Article 78 - ministerial oath. D. Article 77 - parliamentary privilege; Article 78 - dissolution.

Answer: A.

Article 77 structures executive business in the President's name; Article 78 sustains the constitutional communication channel.

OM22. State Council

Which statement is correct?

A. Governor may permanently reject reconsidered advice in all matters. B. It is collectively responsible to the Legislative Assembly, and the 15% cap is subject to a minimum of 12 ministers. C. State Council is collectively responsible to Legislative Council wherever one exists. D. A non-legislator State minister has a twelve-month window.

Answer: B.

Article 164 mirrors the lower-House confidence rule, applies a six-month membership window and imposes the cap/minimum.

OM23. Three responsibility concepts

Which classification is correct?

A. Individual responsibility means Rajya Sabha can dismiss one minister. B. Legal responsibility and collective responsibility are identical. C. Collective responsibility concerns the team before Lok Sabha; individual tenure operates through pleasure/PM advice; India lacks the British universal countersignature model. D. Collective responsibility means each minister must countersign every presidential act.

Answer: C.

The three concepts answer different questions: survival of ministry, tenure of individual minister, and formal legal authentication/countersignature.

OM24. Advanced labels

Which is correct?

A. "Prime-ministerial government" is text in Article 78. B. "Cabinet dictatorship" is a binding Supreme Court doctrine. C. "Elective dictatorship" abolishes the need for elections. D. These are analytical labels for power distribution and must not be treated as constitutional rules.

Answer: D.

Bagehot, Jennings, Laski/Muir, Crossman/Mackintosh and core-executive analysis help interpret practice; the Constitution remains the legal framework.

Remedial MCQs

RM1. Advice after reconsideration

The President returns advice once. The Council reaffirms it. What follows?

A. The President must act according to the reconsidered advice. B. The President may refer it to Rajya Sabha. C. The advice automatically lapses. D. The President may call a referendum.

Answer: A.

The 44th Amendment created a single reconsideration opportunity, not a permanent veto.

RM2. Confidence chamber

Which body can remove the Union Council through a no-confidence motion?

A. Joint sitting B. Lok Sabha C. Rajya Sabha alone D. Supreme Court

Answer: B.

Article 75(3) fixes collective responsibility to Lok Sabha. Courts enforce law; they do not hold confidence votes.

RM3. Six-month rule

A person appointed minister while not a member of Parliament:

A. receives automatic Rajya Sabha membership. B. must enter Lok Sabha only. C. must become a member of either House within six consecutive months or cease to be minister. D. can never vote but may remain for five years.

Answer: C.

The temporary exception preserves appointment flexibility while requiring legislative connection.

RM4. Government versus sovereignty

Which statement is correct?

A. India follows British parliamentary sovereignty. B. Parliamentary government always makes Parliament legally unlimited. C. Judicial review is incompatible with responsible government. D. India has parliamentary government within a supreme, judicially enforceable Constitution.

Answer: D.

The confidence relationship and the location of final legal authority are separate constitutional questions.

RM5. US “Kitchen Cabinet”

The safest statement is:

A. A kitchen cabinet is an informal adviser circle, not the constitutional machinery of US departmental secretaries. B. It is the US lower House. C. Its members must be senators. D. It is collectively responsible to Congress.

Answer: A.

This correction prevents a common textbook-label overreach.

RM6. Government defeat

Which formulation is most accurate?

A. Rajya Sabha alone determines Union confidence. B. No-confidence or denial of essential supply is decisive/grave; other defeats require context. C. Every lost division automatically dissolves Lok Sabha. D. Financial business never affects confidence.

Answer: B.

Confidence doctrine is serious but should not be converted into an automatic rule for every bill or amendment.

RM7. Floor test

The floor-test doctrine is most directly associated in this package with:

A. appointment of Supreme Court judges. B. election of the President. C. disputed State-government majority and Article 356 review. D. authentication under Article 77.

Answer: C.

Use Bommai to show that majority is proved in the representative chamber; take procedural Governor detail to Polity 19.

RM8. Article 82A status

As of the package control date:

A. The President has notified the first simultaneous cycle. B. The Supreme Court has approved a final implementation year. C. Article 82A has already shortened every Assembly term. D. Article 82A remains proposed text in a pending constitutional-amendment Bill.

Answer: D.

The proposal is relevant to the stability-accountability debate only; it is not current law.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Verified routed PYQs

PYQ 1 - UPSC Prelims 2020, GS-I, Q11

Question: A Parliamentary System of Government is one in which:

A. all political parties in the Parliament are represented in the Government B. the Government is responsible to the Parliament and can be removed by it C. the Government is elected by the people and can be removed by them D. the Government is chosen by the Parliament but cannot be removed by it before completion of a fixed term

INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: B.

- A is wrong: an opposition remains outside government; an all-party ministry is not a defining requirement.
- B is correct: political responsibility and removability through the lower House are the controlling features.
- C is wrong: electors choose legislators; the ministry ordinarily emerges through the House majority and is removed by confidence procedure.
- D is wrong: fixed, confidence-independent tenure is presidential, not parliamentary.
- **Confidence:** Very high. The local official question is verified; the historical official key is not held locally.

PYQ 2 - UPSC Prelims 2021, GS-I, Q77

Question: We adopted parliamentary democracy based on the British model, but how does our model differ from that model?

1. As regards legislation, the British Parliament is supreme or sovereign, but in India, the power of Parliament to legislate is limited.
2. In India, matters related to the constitutionality of the amendment of an Act of Parliament are referred to the Constitution Bench by the Supreme Court.

Select the correct answer:

A. 1 only B. 2 only C. Both 1 and 2 D. Neither 1 nor 2

INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: C.

- Statement 1 is correct: Indian legislation is limited by legislative competence, Fundamental Rights, other constitutional provisions and judicial review; orthodox British doctrine treats Parliament as sovereign.
- Statement 2 is accepted as correct in the PYQ's intended frame: Article 145(3) requires at least five judges where a case involves a substantial question of law as to constitutional interpretation.
- [LIMIT] Not every routine statutory challenge becomes a Constitution Bench matter; the constitutional threshold is a **substantial question of interpretation**.
- **Confidence:** High. The local official question is verified; the historical official key is not held locally.

PYQ 3 - UPSC GS-II 2024, Q3 - direct owner

Question: "The growth of cabinet system has practically resulted in the marginalisation of the parliamentary supremacy." Elucidate. **10 marks | 150 words**

Demand decoding

- "Elucidate" requires mechanism and evidence, not a generic merits/demerits list.
- "Parliamentary supremacy" must be clarified as effective control and deliberation, not UK-style legal sovereignty.
- A high-scoring answer should accept the tendency, identify correctives and give a qualified verdict.

Model solution

Article 75(3) makes the cabinet responsible to Lok Sabha, yet the same fusion can let the executive dominate its scrutineer. A disciplined majority and Tenth Schedule-backed whip reduce independent legislative voting. Cabinet control of House time, guillotining of grants and limited committee referral compress scrutiny. Delegated legislation, ordinances under Article 123 and an overbroad Money Bill route can further reduce prior parliamentary examination; PM-centred coordination concentrates agenda power.

Parliament nevertheless retains no-confidence, Question Hour, motions, DRSC and PAC-CAG scrutiny, while courts enforce constitutional limits.

Thus, cabinet growth has marginalised Parliament's **deliberative and control functions**, not created British-style sovereignty. More sittings, routine committee referral and narrower whip use are the appropriate correctives.

Why this earns marks

- Opens with Article 75(3) and directly resolves the sovereignty/supremacy ambiguity.
- Uses a mechanism chain: majority -> whip -> agenda/time -> executive law tools -> PM concentration.
- Adds named correctives and a reform-oriented, qualified conclusion within 10-mark scope.

How to improve this answer

- In 150 words, retain only three dominance mechanisms: whip, control of House time and executive law-making tools; compress correctives into one final sentence.
- Draw a one-line chain - fusion -> disciplined majority -> agenda control -> weaker scrutiny - if space permits.

PYQ 4 - UPSC GS-II 2018, Q13 - supporting/cross-owned

Question: India and USA are two large democracies. Examine the basic tenets on which the two political systems are based. **15 marks | 250 words**

Ownership label: Cross-owned by comparative constitutional design; included here because parliamentary-presidential structure is central to the demand.

Demand decoding

- "Examine" requires both common constitutional commitments and structural differences.
- Avoid reducing the answer to a table of President versus PM.
- Use evidence from constitutional form, federalism, rights, review and accountability.

Model solution

India and the United States are constitutional, federal, republican democracies committed to representative government, rights and judicial review. Their basic tenets overlap, but the institutional routes differ.

Common foundations: Both derive authority from written Constitutions, divide power federally, protect enforceable rights and entrust courts with constitutional review. Bicameral legislatures and periodic elections provide representation and democratic legitimacy.

Different executive principles: India adopts responsible parliamentary government. Articles 74-75 create a dual executive: the President is the formal head, while the PM-Council governs subject to Lok Sabha confidence. The United States has a single elected President with fixed tenure; cabinet secretaries cannot sit in Congress and are not collectively responsible to it.

Different separation logic: India uses functional fusion and coordination, qualified by judicial review and federal distribution. The US uses a stricter separation with presidential veto, Senate confirmation and congressional oversight, creating checks but also deadlock risk.

Federal and political variation: India has a stronger Union, single citizenship and an integrated judiciary; the US combines stronger States, dual political citizenship and dual court structures. Indian anti-defection discipline strengthens executive control; US divided government intensifies bargaining.

Therefore, both systems seek limited democratic government, but India prioritises daily legislative responsibility, whereas the US prioritises fixed tenure and institutional separation. Neither model ensures accountability or stability automatically; outcomes depend on parties, federal practice and constitutional restraint.

Why this earns marks

- Answers "basic tenets" through shared foundations plus institutional differences.
- Uses named Articles and exact comparison axes rather than slogans.
- Includes effects and qualifications: responsibility versus stability, fusion versus deadlock, strong Union versus State autonomy.

How to improve this answer

- Use a two-column India/USA mini-table for executive, federal and judicial axes, then reserve the prose for consequences; this prevents a descriptive country-by-country answer.
- If compressed, retain Articles 74-75, fixed tenure/separation and one federal contrast before the qualified conclusion.

PYQ 5 - UPSC GS-II 2023, Q4 - supporting/cross-owned

Question: Compare and contrast the British and Indian approaches to Parliamentary sovereignty. **10 marks | 150 words**

Ownership label: Cross-owned by comparative constitutional design; included here to prevent confusion between parliamentary government and parliamentary sovereignty.

Model solution

Britain and India share responsible cabinet government, but not the same source of legal supremacy.

Under orthodox British doctrine, Parliament may enact or repeal any law; courts cannot invalidate an Act merely for inconsistency with a superior codified Constitution. Conventions regulate much executive practice.

India adopts **constitutional supremacy**. Parliament's competence is limited by the Seventh Schedule, Fundamental Rights and other constitutional provisions, and laws face judicial review. Even Article 368 power is limited by the basic-structure doctrine; federalism and bicameralism further distribute authority.

The similarity is political: in both systems the cabinet survives through lower-House confidence and normally leads the legislative agenda. India therefore borrowed Westminster responsibility but constitutionalised and limited Parliament. British sovereignty concerns legal competence; Indian parliamentary supremacy means political control over the executive within a supreme Constitution.

Why this earns marks

- Defines the precise legal contrast before listing institutional evidence.
- Uses Seventh Schedule, Fundamental Rights, judicial review, Article 368 and basic structure.
- Ends by separating sovereignty from responsible government, the core trap in the question.

How to improve this answer

- Open with same responsible-government form, different source of legal supremacy; this answers "compare and contrast" immediately.
- In a strict 150-word attempt, use three Indian limits only: federal competence, rights/judicial review and the basic-structure limit.

Original Mains practice with model solutions

M1. 10 marks | 150 words

Question: Explain how Articles 74, 75, 77, 78 and 88 together convert formal executive power into responsible government.

Demand decoding

- "Explain how" requires an integrated mechanism, not five isolated Article definitions.
- Connect advice, appointment, business form, information and parliamentary participation.

Model solution

The Constitution formally vests Union executive power in the President, but five provisions make its exercise responsible.

Article 74 places a PM-headed Council to aid and advise the President; after one reconsideration, advice binds, while Article 74(2) protects the advice from inquiry. Article 75 gives democratic content: ministers operate in a PM-led team

and are collectively responsible to Lok Sabha; a non-member must enter Parliament within six months.

Article 77 expresses executive action in the President's name and authorises business rules. Article 78 requires the PM to communicate decisions and information, preserving consultation without personal presidential government. Article 88 lets ministers participate in either House, though voting follows membership.

Thus, the President supplies constitutional form, the Council makes political choices and Lok Sabha controls the ministry's survival.

Why this earns marks

- Integrates all five Articles through one causal chain.
- Uses the reconsideration, six-month and voting caveats.
- Ends with a crisp nominal-head/real-executive/confidence synthesis.

How to improve this answer

- Group the provisions as 'decision (74-75) -> legal form (77) -> information (78) -> House presence (88)' instead of writing five isolated definitions.
- Omit secondary clause detail if the answer exceeds 150 words; keep collective responsibility and the Article 88 voting caveat.

M2. 10 marks | 150 words

Question: Collective responsibility is both a rule of government survival and a rule of cabinet solidarity. Analyse with judicial support.

Demand decoding

- Address both confidence and solidarity.
- Use at least two cases and qualify dissolution/floor-test context.

Model solution

Article 75(3) makes collective responsibility the bedrock of Union parliamentary government in two senses.

Survival: The Council must retain Lok Sabha confidence. A carried no-confidence motion requires resignation or a constitutionally proper dissolution route. Denial of essential supply is grave, though not every legislative defeat equals confidence loss.

Solidarity: Ministers may disagree internally, but must publicly defend settled policy or resign. Parliament therefore confronts one accountable government.

U.N.R. Rao (1971) held that dissolution does not terminate the Council: Article 74 preserves continuity while confidence can be tested only when a House exists. *Shamsher Singh* (1974) located political responsibility in the advice-giving ministry. At State level, *Subhash Desai* (2023) required objective material of lost House confidence before a Governor-directed floor test; intra-party disagreement alone is insufficient.

Thus, collective responsibility combines solidarity inside government with confidence before the House; it neither prohibits internal debate nor makes every lost vote fatal.

Why this earns marks

- Separates the two limbs named in the question.
- Uses three cases for different propositions rather than decorative citation.
- Adds the supply/ordinary-defeat and State-level qualifications.

How to improve this answer

- Use one case for continuity (*U.N.R. Rao*) and one for the floor-test limit (*Subhash Desai*); additional cases should appear only if space remains.
- Finish with a two-part verdict - solidarity inside government, confidence before the House - to mirror the question exactly.

M3. 15 marks | 250 words

Question: Compare parliamentary and presidential systems and assess why the parliamentary form remains better suited to India's constitutional conditions.

Demand decoding

- Comparison must use exact axes.
- Assessment needs Indian reasons, counterarguments and a graded verdict.

Model solution

Parliamentary and presidential systems differ primarily in the relationship between executive and legislature.

Axis	Parliamentary	Presidential
Executive	Formal head plus real ministry	Single political executive
Selection	Ministry from legislative support	President separately elected
Tenure	Confidence-dependent	Fixed
Responsibility	Daily to lower House	Not politically responsible to legislature
Membership	Ministers sit in legislature	Executive officers cannot sit in legislature
Structure	Fusion and coordination	Separation and checks

India preferred the parliamentary form for four connected reasons. First, Ambedkar prioritised greater responsibility over the presidential model's greater fixed-term stability. Questions, motions and no-confidence make accountability continuous rather than merely periodic. Second, constitutional experience under late-colonial reforms made responsible institutions administratively familiar. Third, fusion reduced the risk of a separately elected executive and legislature producing deadlock in a new democracy. Fourth, a multi-member cabinet offered room for regional, social and coalition representation in a plural federation. The Swaran Singh Committee later favoured retention.

The choice has costs. Short-lived governments demonstrate instability; majority, whip and PMO control can produce cabinet dominance; generalist ministers invite the "amateur" critique. A presidential system offers tenure stability and access to external expertise.

However, Indian evidence qualifies these objections. Full-term coalitions show that fragmentation need not cause collapse. Expert administration can be supplied without making the executive confidence-independent, while constitutional supremacy, federalism and courts check concentration.

The alternative must also be judged institutionally: fixed tenure can prevent collapse, but divided government may produce policy deadlock without creating daily legislative responsibility.

Therefore, parliamentary government remains better suited not because it guarantees good governance, but because its confidence principle, replaceability and coalition capacity align with India's need for continuous accountability and plural accommodation. Reform should strengthen Parliament rather than replace responsible government.

Why this earns marks

- Gives an exact comparison before evaluation.
- Uses Ambedkar, institutional familiarity, pluralism, Swaran Singh and coalition counterevidence.
- Acknowledges presidential advantages and parliamentary failures before defending a qualified Indian choice.

How to improve this answer

- Keep the comparison table to six axes and spend the saved words evaluating Indian suitability; the examiner rewards the assessment, not a catalogue.
- Add one counterweight - fixed-tenure stability or deadlock risk - immediately before the verdict.

M4. 15 marks | 250 words

Question: "Cabinet dominance in India is a product of constitutional fusion amplified by party and procedural power." Discuss.

Demand decoding

- Separate the constitutional base from political amplifiers.
- Explain consequences and correctives; avoid calling the cabinet legally sovereign.

Model solution

Articles 74-75 create a ministry drawn from Parliament and sustained by Lok Sabha confidence. This fusion enables coordination, but does not alone explain cabinet dominance.

Party amplification: A governing majority controls House outcomes. The whip, backed where applicable by Tenth Schedule disqualification risk, prioritises party survival over independent legislative judgment.

Procedural amplification: Government business occupies most agenda time. Guillotining grants compresses financial scrutiny. Delegated legislation, Article 123 ordinances and an overbroad Money Bill route can reduce prior or bicameral examination. PM control of appointments, information and coordination may further convert cabinet into prime-ministerial government.

Evidence: PRS records 274 sitting days for the full-term 17th Lok Sabha and only 16% of Bills referred to committees. This indicates reduced opportunity, not that every enactment lacked scrutiny.

The concentration is therefore reinforced by an information asymmetry: ministers command the administration and legislative timetable, while ordinary members depend on limited research time, committee access and disclosure.

Correctives: Article 75(3), Question Hour, DRSCs, PAC-CAG scrutiny, opposition, bicameralism, courts and elections constrain the executive. Judicial review matters because India follows constitutional, not parliamentary, sovereignty.

Thus, cabinet dominance is **fusion plus disciplined majority plus control of procedure and information**. It marginalises deliberation, not Parliament's constitutional capacity. More sittings, committee referral and narrower whip use are the remedy.

Why this earns marks

- Directly tests and proves both parts of the quotation.
- Adds precise instruments, PRS evidence and constitutional correctives.
- Avoids the major conceptual error of equating executive dominance with legal sovereignty.

How to improve this answer

- Organise the body under constitutional base, party/procedural amplifiers, effects and correctives; this makes the causal argument visible.

- Use either the 274 sitting-day statistic or the 16% referral statistic in the exam, not both, if the word limit is tight.

M5. 20 marks | 250-300 words

Question: Critically evaluate whether India's parliamentary system has delivered responsibility at an unacceptable cost to stability and policy continuity.

Demand decoding

- "Critically evaluate" requires criteria, positive evidence, negative evidence, counterevidence and a reasoned threshold judgment.
- Responsibility, stability and continuity must all be addressed.

Model solution

India's framers preferred day-to-day responsibility to fixed-term stability. The test is whether confidence-based instability prevents governance without improving accountability.

Responsibility delivered: Article 75(3) makes survival depend on Lok Sabha confidence. Questions, committees, financial voting and no-confidence enable continuing scrutiny and replacement without constitutional rupture.

Shamsher Singh locates responsibility in the advice-giving Council; *U.N.R. Rao* preserves ministerial continuity during dissolution.

Costs: Short-lived governments in 1979, 1989-91 and 1996-98 show that coalition bargaining and defection can delay decisions and disrupt policy. Confidence incentives may also encourage short-term calculation.

Counterevidence: Full-term coalitions after 1999 show that negotiated programmes, anti-defection discipline and institutional learning can produce stability. Bureaucratic, judicial and intergovernmental institutions preserve substantial policy continuity. Presidential tenure would reduce one instability but risk executive-legislative deadlock and personal concentration.

Deeper deficit: Majority whips, reduced sittings, weak committee referral and PMO centralisation can make government stable while Parliament becomes less deliberative. PRS's 274-day figure for the 17th Lok Sabha illustrates this concern.

Judicial floor-test doctrine supplies a boundary: *Subhash Desai* (2023) requires objective material of lost House confidence and rejects use of a floor test merely to resolve an intra-party dispute. This protects accountability from becoming partisan constitutional intervention.

Judgment: Instability is a designed accountability cost, unacceptable only when fragmentation defeats governance without enabling scrutiny. India's record is mixed, not a system failure. Coalition transparency, stronger committees, predictable sittings and protected federal accountability are preferable to abandoning responsible government.

Why this earns marks

- Establishes explicit evaluation criteria and follows them.
- Uses Articles, cases, historical instability, coalition counterevidence and PRS evidence.
- Reframes the debate by showing that excessive executive stability can coexist with weak legislative responsibility.

How to improve this answer

- State the evaluation threshold in the introduction: instability is unacceptable only when it prevents governance without improving accountability.
- Compress historical examples into one line and devote the extra space to reforms that restore scrutiny without abandoning confidence government.

M6. 20 marks | 250-300 words

Question: The simultaneous-elections proposal revives the parliamentary dilemma between stability and accountability. Examine the constitutional trade-offs without treating the proposal as current law.

Demand decoding

- Begin with the verified pending status.
- Use the proposal only as a system-design debate.
- Balance governance claims against confidence flexibility, federalism and voter accountability.

Model solution

The Constitution (One Hundred and Twenty-Ninth Amendment) Bill, 2024 proposes Article 82A for simultaneous Lok Sabha and Assembly elections. As of 28 August 2026 it remains under Joint Committee review after a 30 July extension to report by the Winter Session 2026: it is not law and no implementation year is established.

Stability case: Fewer election cycles may create a predictable administrative calendar, reduce repeated mobilisation and lengthen policy horizons. This seeks some benefits of tenure stability without replacing parliamentary government.

Accountability cost: A parliamentary ministry may fall on losing House confidence. The remainder-term design after premature dissolution may create very short legislatures merely to restore the common cycle, weakening a fresh mandate and privileging calendar preservation.

The Bill also permits an Election Commission recommendation to defer a particular Assembly election. Any final design therefore needs a time limit, transparent reasons and a route that prevents prolonged absence of an elected Assembly.

Federal concern: State elections express State-specific accountability. Synchronisation may nationalise campaigns; deferring an Assembly election also raises representative-continuity and constitutional-safeguard questions.

Design: Ambedkar's formulation remains apt: no system maximises stability and responsibility equally. Expenditure and convenience cannot by themselves displace confidence, federalism and voter sanction; staggered elections are

not automatically superior either.

Judgment: Test the proposal for necessity, proportionality, federal consultation, workable early dissolution and protection of House confidence. Stability must serve, not freeze, responsibility. Until enactment, this remains an analytical illustration, not constitutional law.

Why this earns marks

- Opens with exact current control and repeats the non-law qualification.
- Organises analysis into stability, accountability, federalism and design.
- Uses Ambedkar's frame and provides a constitutional test rather than a partisan verdict.

How to improve this answer

- Put Bill, not law in the first line and avoid predicting an implementation year.
- Use a four-box answer plan - stability, confidence flexibility, federalism, safeguards - and end with conditions for constitutionally acceptable design rather than a yes/no political position.